Reuniting and Rediscovering India

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India's system of governance and statecraft has traditionally relied on a mutual agreement between political parties regarding important socio-economic and political issues. While there may be disagreements on how to achieve these shared objectives, there has always been a consensus on the overarching goals. This democratic protocol, developed over the years, allows India to present a unified front on crucial matters such as national security, foreign policy and diplomatic affairs. The rationale behind this approach is rooted in the belief that all stakeholders in India, representing diverse interests and perspectives, should be consulted. This ensures that the entire nation is actively involved in determining national goals and outcomes. The emphasis on inclusivity and collaboration underscores India's commitment to democratic principles and the idea that collective decision-making leads to a more united and effective nation.

That consensus and process is sadly wearing thin, which makes it all the more necessary for the Opposition to stick together. As our Prime Minister has said time and again, a strong and vibrant Opposition is essential for the survival of our democracy.

It is no coincidence that the Opposition parties (which today represent 60 per cent of India's population) are forced to champion the people's voices through alternative mechanisms. Rahul Gandhi's Bharat Jodo Yatra needs to be seen in this larger context. The Yatra was forced to traverse 4,000 kilometres from Kanyakumari to Kashmir just so the Opposition could reconnect with the people and raise their concerns using guerrilla tactics. This could be seen as an act of desperation, but it showed tremendous courage and concern for the nation.